

PROSPER AWUNI

Cyber Security Manager | CISSP | ISO 27001 | Cyber Essentials Plus | Vulnerability Management and Incident Response

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of experience designing, building and maturing cyber security programmes across complex organisations. I have deep, hands-on expertise spanning ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus (CE+), risk management, vulnerability management, incident response, identity and access management, and endpoint security. I thrive in environments where I can shape the entire security function, from strategic governance through to hands-on technical implementation. My experience at University of the Arts, London involved building and operationalising security capabilities across an eight-thousand-user estate, working across endpoint protection, Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Privileged Access Management (PAM), and cloud identity. I bring the strategic vision to align cyber security with rapid business growth and the technical depth to deliver it myself, including working with emerging areas such as cloud and artificial intelligence (AI) security. I am eager to own a security function end-to-end in a fast-growing Software as a Service (SaaS) business where I can make a real, visible impact.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Security Programme Leadership:** ISO 27001 implementation and maintenance, Cyber Essentials Plus (CE+) certification, risk management frameworks, security strategy development
- **Risk and Compliance Management:** Information security risk registers, control gap analysis, third-party risk, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus; penetration test oversight and findings remediation
- **Incident Response:** NIST SP 800-61 lifecycle, MITRE ATT&CK framework, threat hunting, forensic triage, post-incident review
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, NG-SIEM, Insight), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE)
- **SIEM / SOAR:** Microsoft Sentinel, Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection engineering, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook automation
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM, privileged account governance
- **Cloud Security:** Azure security controls, Microsoft Defender for Cloud, cloud access policies, secure configuration baselines
- **Email and Web Security:** Mimecast, Web Application Firewall (WAF) management, Distributed Denial of Service (DDoS) protection
- **Mobile Device Management (MDM) / Mobile Application Management (MAM):** Microsoft Intune, device compliance, application protection
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting, SOAR automation, workflow orchestration
- **Certifications:** CISSP, CompTIA Security+, Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA), CompTIA A+, Google IT Support Professional Certificate

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Own the cyber security programme across endpoint, identity, SIEM, vulnerability management, and incident response disciplines, taking personal accountability for the security posture of the institution.

- Lead ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus (CE+) compliance activities including risk register maintenance, control evidence, internal reviews and external assessments, driving continuous improvement of the control environment.
- Manage the information security risk management programme, assessing and tracking risks across the organisation, prioritising remediation activities and reporting to senior leadership on residual risk position.
- Direct the vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io and Pentera BAS, conducting regular assessments, commissioning penetration tests and tracking findings through to validated remediation.
- Lead incident response operations end-to-end following NIST SP 800-61, covering detection, containment, eradication, recovery and post-incident review; maintain the organisation's incident response plan.
- Govern identity security through Microsoft Entra ID, administering Conditional Access, MFA, SSO and Group Policy across the eight-thousand-user estate, enforcing least-privilege principles.
- Operate and optimise CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, managing prevention policies, detection tuning, threat intelligence integration and sensor deployment across all endpoints.
- Manage Microsoft Sentinel SIEM, developing KQL-based detection rules and SOAR playbooks to automate alert triage and incident escalation, reducing mean time to detect and respond.
- Administer BeyondTrust PAM, securing privileged access through credential vaulting, session monitoring and access governance workflows.
- Manage AI-related security considerations as the organisation adopts AI and cloud-native services, advising on data governance, access controls and risk associated with AI platform adoption.
- Provide security input to strategic technology decisions, ensuring cyber security requirements are embedded into new projects, vendor assessments and architectural changes from the outset.
- Deliver security awareness training and phishing simulation campaigns across the organisation, tracking and improving staff security culture.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Contributed to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus (CE+) compliance activities, gathering evidence, performing control testing and supporting internal and external audits.
- Supported the information security risk register, identifying emerging risks and tracking mitigation actions to completion.
- Ran vulnerability scanning using Tenable.io and AppCheck, producing risk-rated remediation reports for IT teams and monitoring progress against agreed timelines.
- Managed SIEM operations in Microsoft Sentinel, triaging security alerts, investigating incidents and developing new detection content to improve threat coverage.
- Deployed and configured CrowdStrike Falcon across the endpoint estate, establishing detection and prevention policies and integrating with SIEM for centralised event visibility.
- Administered Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), managing user lifecycle, access reviews, Conditional Access tuning and MFA rollout across the user base.
- Conducted threat hunting using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and KQL in Microsoft Sentinel, proactively identifying indicators of compromise and anomalous behaviour.
- Supported incident response operations, performing initial triage, forensic analysis and contributing to remediation and lessons-learned activities.
- Managed Mimecast email security policies, investigating email-borne threats including phishing, malware delivery and business email compromise.
- Delivered security awareness training and coordinated phishing simulation campaigns to reduce organisational risk from social engineering.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service / FinTech)

- Managed end-to-end information security in a SaaS and FinTech environment, contributing to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials compliance activities including risk assessments, evidence gathering and control gap analysis.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments and managed remediation, producing risk-rated findings reports for technical and business stakeholders.

- Administered endpoint security, firewall, network access controls and identity tooling, ensuring security baselines were consistently enforced across the infrastructure estate.
- Supported third-party security assessments and vendor risk reviews, contributing to the organisation's supply chain security posture.
- Collaborated with engineering and development teams to embed security into software delivery processes, supporting secure-by-design practices in a SaaS product environment.
- Maintained infrastructure availability and performance across cloud and on-premises environments, balancing security requirements with operational continuity.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built and sustained ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus (CE+) compliance programmes at UAL, coordinating across multiple technical teams to evidence and close control gaps through structured governance cycles.
- Delivered Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) exercises to validate security control effectiveness against real-world attack scenarios, generating actionable findings that drove targeted remediation.
- Implemented BeyondTrust PAM to eliminate standing privileged access to critical systems, establishing credential vaulting and session monitoring as a core security control.
- Led the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint across an eight-thousand-user estate, unifying endpoint visibility under a single security platform and improving detection coverage materially.
- Engineered a library of KQL-based SIEM detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, including rules targeting identity-based attacks and cloud-hosted threat actors, reducing mean time to detect for critical alert categories.
- Automated security incident triage through SOAR playbook development, enabling consistent, documented response to high-volume alert categories and freeing analyst capacity for complex investigations.
- Contributed hands-on security architecture input to AI and cloud service adoption decisions at UAL, assessing data exposure risk and access control requirements for new AI-powered platforms.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)